

PRESENT LIKE THE INSIDER

Turn factory data into decisions.

By Ah Hock · The Industrial Scribe · theindustrialscribe.com

What the customer buys for USD 19.99: the complete method a manufacturing office person needs to turn raw factory data into presentations that customers and bosses actually act on — the framework, the chart-choice map, four AI prompts, a worked before/after example, and the TIS pre-ship checklist. This is the skill Ah Hock is personally known for, taught properly.

The core idea

Nobody in a factory gets paid for making charts. You get paid for making decisions happen. The difference between a report that gets ignored and one that gets approved is almost never the data — it is whether the person presenting knew what the data was supposed to make the audience DO. That is a framework skill, not a design talent. And with AI, the production work — the charts, the slides, the speaker notes — takes minutes.

PART 1 — THE SO-WHAT METHOD (THE FRAMEWORK)

Before any chart, any slide, any AI prompt, answer three questions in one sentence each:

1. **WHO is in the room, and what do they already believe?** (Boss thinks delivery is fine · customer suspects quality is slipping · auditor wants proof of control)
2. **WHAT is the one thing the data proves?** One thing. If you have three, you have three slides, not one.

3. **SO WHAT must happen next?** The decision, the approval, the order — the action your presentation exists to trigger.

Then the rule that changes everything: **the answer to question 2 becomes your slide title**. Not "Delivery Performance Q3." Instead: **"On-time delivery recovered to 96% after the layout change."** A title that states the takeaway does half the presenting before you open your mouth.

PART 2 — THE CHART-CHOICE MAP (FACTORY EDITION)

Your message is about...	Use	Factory example
Comparing a few things	Bar chart (start axis at zero)	Defects by machine · output by line
Change over time	Line chart	OTD trend · scrap rate by month
The vital few causes	Pareto (bars sorted big → small + cumulative line)	NCR causes — the factory classic
Parts of a whole	Stacked bar (avoid pie beyond 3 slices)	Downtime split by reason
Before vs after	Paired bars, old grey / new colour	Cycle time before/after improvement
One big number	Just the number, huge	"RM 42,000 saved" needs no chart

The default nobody teaches: when in doubt, a sorted bar chart with a takeaway title beats everything fancy. Fancy is for impressing designers; sorted bars are for winning approvals.

PART 3 — THE DECLUTTER PASS (60 SECONDS PER CHART)

- Delete: 3D effects, background shading, heavy gridlines, borders, the legend if you can label the lines directly
- One accent colour for the thing that matters; everything else grey (your eye goes where the colour is — use that on purpose)
- Round the numbers: 96%, not 96.37% — precision the audience can't act on is noise
- The squint test: blur your eyes; if the main point doesn't survive, the chart isn't done

PART 4 — THE FOUR AI PROMPTS

PROMPT 1 — Data → Story (run this first, every time)

You are a manufacturing presentation coach. I will paste raw data and tell you who the audience is and what I need them to decide. Your job is NOT to summarise the data — it is to find the one message that drives the decision.

AUDIENCE: [e.g. my GM, monthly ops meeting / customer quality manager, complaint review]

DECISION I NEED: [e.g. approve overtime budget / accept our corrective action and keep the business]

DATA: [paste your table here]

GIVE ME:

1. The ONE key message, written as a slide title that states the takeaway (max 12 words)
2. The best chart for that message and why (bar / line / Pareto / stacked / big number)
3. What to leave OUT of this presentation and why
4. The one number the audience will challenge — and the backup answer I should prepare
5. A 3-sentence speaker note: what I say when this slide is on screen

RULES: No jargon. If the data does not actually support a clear message, say so — do not invent one.

PROMPT 2 – The Management Update (Situation → Change → So What → Ask)

Build me a management update presentation from my notes. Audience: [boss / management meeting]. Use exactly this structure, one slide each:

1. SITUATION – where we stand, one takeaway title + max 3 numbers
2. WHAT CHANGED – what moved since last update, good and bad, no hiding
3. SO WHAT – what it means for cost, delivery, or customers, in money or days where possible
4. THE ASK – the decision or support I need, stated as one sentence with a deadline

MY NOTES: [brain-dump here – messy is fine]

For each slide give me: the takeaway title, the content (bullets or a chart suggestion from my data), and a 2-sentence speaker note. Keep every slide answerable in 60 seconds – this is a factory meeting, not a conference.

PROMPT 3 – The Customer-Facing Deck (business review / complaint response / capability intro)

Build a customer-facing presentation. Formal, confident, professional Asian B2B English – no flowery language, no apologising beyond one sincere line if this is a complaint response.

TYPE: [business review / corrective action presentation / capability introduction]

CUSTOMER CONTEXT: [who they are, what they care about, what happened]

MY MATERIAL: [paste data, findings, actions taken]

STRUCTURE it as: (1) purpose in one line, (2) the facts with takeaway titles, (3) actions and evidence, (4) commitment and next steps with dates.

RULES: Every claim needs a number or a date. Never blame individuals – processes fail, people don't. Never promise what I did not tell you we can do. End with what we need FROM the customer, if anything.

PROMPT 4 – The Chart Doctor (paste any chart before it ships)

You are a ruthless chart reviewer. I will describe or screenshot a chart I made. Critique it in this order:

1. TITLE – does it state the takeaway, or just name the topic?
2. MESSAGE – can you tell in 5 seconds what I want the audience to conclude? If not, why?
3. CHART TYPE – is there a simpler chart that says it better?
4. CLUTTER – list everything I should delete
5. THE FIX – describe the corrected chart in one paragraph

Be direct. If the chart should be a sentence instead ("just say the number"), tell me.

MY CHART: [describe or paste]

PART 5 – WORKED EXAMPLE (BEFORE / AFTER)

Before: "Monthly Quality Report" – a 14-column defect table, all reasons listed alphabetically, three pie charts, title "Quality Data September". Boss reaction: "okay, noted." ~~Nothing happens.~~

After the method: One Pareto chart, sorted. Title: **"Two causes make 71% of our defects – both on Machine 7."** One ask: "Approve 4 hours downtime for Machine 7 alignment this Saturday." Boss reaction: approved in the meeting. (*Illustrative example – anonymised.*)

PART 6 – PRESENT BY YOUR BUSINESS NATURE (LINKS TO MODULE 01)

Nature

Your presentations must
prove

Lead with

A — Commodity Volume	Consistency and reliability	Trend lines: OTD, rejection rate, response time
B — High-Mix Custom	Capability and speed	Case examples: problem → solution → turnaround days
C — Qualified Precision	Control and traceability	Process data, audit trails, capability indices
D — Captive/Tier-Dependent	Your value contribution	Cost-saved and problems-solved, in RM, per quarter

PART 7 — THE TIS PRE-SHIP CHECKLIST (THE LAST PAGE OF THE PDF)

1. Does every slide title state a takeaway, not a topic?
2. One message per slide — ruthlessly?
3. Is the ask written on an actual slide, with a date?
4. Bar charts start at zero? Numbers rounded to what the audience can act on?
5. One accent colour, rest grey — colour only where the point is?
6. Could the busiest person in the room repeat your main message after 5 seconds? (the squint test for words)
7. Do you know which number will be challenged, and is the backup ready?
8. Source and date on every chart?
9. Deleted everything the audience cannot act on?
10. If the whole deck died and you had 60 seconds in the corridor — can you still make the ask? (If yes, you're ready.)

Originality & honesty (for the sales page)

- 100% original TIS content — general presentation craft + Ah Hock's factory method + AI prompts. No copied playbooks.

- No invented testimonials or buyer counts. Worked example labeled anonymised/illustrative until Ah Hock supplies a real one.
- Positioning: "the skill that made the BD guy" — flagship module, USD 19.99.

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